RRB NTPC History PYQs: Post-Gupta & Chola Dynasty

Authentic Previous Year Questions with Answers, Explanations & Exam Shift Details

QUESTION 1 • POST-GUPTA LITERATURE

Who was the author of the famous Sanskrit play *Nagananda*?

(A) Banabhatta

(B) Harshavardhana

(C) Bhavabhuti

(D) Kalidasa

Correct Answer: (B) Harshavardhana

Exam Shift: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (28 December 2020, Shift-2)

Explanation: Emperor **Harshavardhana** (reigned 606–647 CE) of the Pushyabhuti dynasty was an accomplished scholar and playwright. He authored three famous Sanskrit plays: *Nagananda*, *Ratnavali*, and *Priyadarshika*. His court poet **Banabhatta** wrote his biography, *Harshacharita*.

QUESTION 2 • POST-GUPTA RULERS & BATTLES

Which Chalukya ruler defeated Harshavardhana on the banks of the Narmada River?

(A) Pulakeshin I

(B) Kirtivarman I

(C) Pulakeshin II

(D) Vikramaditya I

Correct Answer: (C) Pulakeshin II

Exam Shift: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (16 January 2021, Shift-1)

Explanation: Pulakeshin II, the greatest ruler of the Badami Chalukya dynasty, halted Harshavardhana's southward expansion along the Narmada River around 618 CE. This victory is vividly documented in the **Aihole Inscription**, composed by his court poet Ravikirti.

QUESTION 3 • CHOLA DYNASTY RULERS

Who was the last ruler of the Imperial Chola dynasty?

(A) Rajaraja Chola II

(B) Rajendra Chola III

(C) Vijayalaya Chola

(D) Kulottunga Chola III

Correct Answer: (B) Rajendra Chola III

Exam Shift: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (28 April 2016, Shift-3)

Explanation: Rajendra Chola III (reigned 1246–1279 CE) was the last ruler of the Chola dynasty. By his reign, the Chola empire had weakened significantly due to the rise of the Pandyas in the south and the Hoysalas in the north, leading to the end of Chola rule. (Note: **Vijayalaya Chola** was the founder of the Imperial Chola dynasty around 850 CE).

QUESTION 4 • CHOLA ART & ARCHITECTURE

Which Chola ruler built the famous Brihadeshwara Temple at Thanjavur (Tanjore)?

(A) Rajendra Chola I

(B) Rajaraja Chola I

(C) Karikala Chola

(D) Aditya Chola I

Correct Answer: (B) Rajaraja Chola I

Exam Shift: RRB NTPC CBT-1 (04 March 2021, Shift-2)

Explanation: Rajaraja Chola I constructed the magnificent **Brihadeshwara Temple** (also known as Rajarajeswaram) between 1003 and 1010 CE in Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu. Built entirely of granite and dedicated to Lord Shiva, it is a pinnacle of Dravidian architecture and a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

QUESTION 5 • CHOLA NAVAL EXPEDITIONS

Rajendra Chola I is well known for his naval expeditions against the revived Srivijaya Empire located in present-day:

(A) Indonesia

(B) Myanmar

(C) Sri Lanka

(D) Cambodia

Correct Answer: (A) Indonesia

Exam Shift: RRB NTPC (UG) CBT-1 (09 September 2025, Shift-2)

Explanation: Rajendra Chola I possessed one of the strongest navies of the medieval world. In 1025 CE, he launched a massive overseas naval campaign against the **Srivijaya Empire** (centered in Sumatra and the Malay Peninsula in modern-day **Indonesia**) to secure maritime trade routes between India and China.